Our Mission

A Message from the Founder

I founded Somboh Educational Foundation (SEF Ghana) with one conviction: a brilliant young Ghanaian's future should be decided by their ability, effort, and character, and never by the size of their family's bank account.

Our mission is to empower students to achieve academic excellence, personal growth, and civic responsibility through innovative, inclusive, and comprehensive educational programs. We are committed to providing equitable access to college preparatory resources, skills development, and community engagement opportunities, fostering a generation of leaders and changemakers.

The Gap We Exist to Close

Ghana has made real progress in opening the doors of secondary education. The Free Senior High School policy, introduced in 2018, provides free tuition at all public secondary schools. But a free secondary education does not guarantee a university education. Of roughly 446,000 candidates who completed WASSCE in 2021, only about 36% entered tertiary education the following year, and education advocates point to financing as a major barrier for needy students.

Studying abroad is growing fast. Ghana now ranks 14th in the world for sending students to the United States, with a record 12,825 Ghanaian students there in 2024/25. Yet only about one in five of them is an undergraduate. The undergraduate path, the one that can transform the life of an eighteen-year-old from a modest home, remains narrow. The reason is rarely ability. It is information, guidance, and money.

What We Do

- **Academic excellence:** SAT preparation, academic coaching, and study support so students can show the full measure of their ability on a global stage.
- **Application mentorship:** one-on-one help with personal statements, supplemental essays, activity lists, and resumes that tell each student's story with depth and honesty.
- **Financial aid and scholarship facilitation:** demystifying need-based aid, preparing financial documentation, identifying universities that meet full demonstrated need for international students, and pursuing fee waivers, so that cost is never the reason a student does not apply.
- **Skills development:** workshops in writing, public speaking, research, digital literacy, and interviewing, preparing students not only to be admitted but to thrive.
- **Community engagement:** encouraging every student to lead and serve at home, long before they leave.

Who We Serve

We serve students from public and private schools, from cities and rural districts, from every region and background across Ghana and West Africa. We look for promise, not privilege: strong academics, curiosity, resilience, and a desire to make a difference. Many of our students are the first in their families to apply to university abroad.

Our Commitment to Ghana

Our goal is not simply to send students away. It is to raise leaders who will return their knowledge, networks, and energy to Ghana and to Africa, as engineers, physicians, entrepreneurs, policymakers, scientists, artists, and educators. Every SEF scholar carries a responsibility to the students coming behind them, so that each scholarship becomes the beginning of a cycle of opportunity.

My Promise

> *To every brilliant student who has been told that the world's best universities are not meant for someone like them: they are.*

To every family that has sacrificed to keep a child in school: you are not alone. And to our partners, donors, and universities around the world: Ghana's young people are ready. With the right preparation and support, they will not only earn their place, they will lead.

With gratitude and resolve,

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Founder, Somboh Educational Foundation (SEF Ghana)

Data sources: Institute of International Education, Open Doors 2025 Ghana Fact Sheet; Ghanaian Times (Open Doors 2024/25); Africa Education Watch via Modern Ghana (WASSCE-to-tertiary transition); Oxford Business Group (Free SHS policy).